

Sports Nutrition Guide

Fueling Performance

Carbohydrates are the primary fuel for moderate-to-high intensity exercise; athletes with high training volume typically need more carbohydrate (often cited 5-10 g/kg bodyweight/day depending on training load) than sedentary individuals.

Pre-workout meals 2-3 hours before training combining carbohydrate and moderate protein support performance without gastrointestinal discomfort.

During & After Exercise

Timing	Focus	Example
During (>60-90 min sessions)	Carbohydrate + electrolytes	Sports drink, banana, dates
Immediately Post	Protein + carbohydrate for recovery	Protein shake + fruit
Within a few hours Post	Balanced meal to complete recovery	Protein, carbs, vegetables

Hydration & Electrolytes

Fluid needs increase with exercise duration, intensity, and heat; thirst plus monitoring urine color are practical everyday guides.

Sessions longer than ~60-90 minutes, especially in heat, benefit from electrolyte replacement (sodium, potassium) alongside fluids.

Sport-Specific Notes

Endurance athletes generally prioritize higher carbohydrate intake and consistent fueling strategy practiced in training before race day.

Strength/power athletes prioritize adequate protein and total calories to support recovery between high-intensity sessions.

Weight-class athletes should approach any cutting practices cautiously and ideally under professional supervision, as aggressive cuts can impair performance and health.